INTERIM AMENDMENT

TO

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TUNNEL, FINISHING, GARMENT, STEAM ELECTRIC

This interim amendment was developed by US Army Natick Laboratories (GL), Natick, Massachusetts 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim amendment as a valid exception to Federal Specification OO-T-1848.

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2.1, under Military Specification. Add "MIL-T-43853 - Trousers, Men's, Tan 445 (Durable Press)".

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3.5.1, add to end of paragraph the following sentence: "The temperature of the exterior surfaces shall not exceed 115°F over 25 percent of its area and shall not exceed more than 200°F over 15 percent of its area during tunnel operation and shall be tested as specified in 4.7.2."

3.5.1.1 Delete first sentence in its entirety and substitute: "The interior of the cabinet shall be provided with means for totally exposing garments to steam."

3.5.1.2.1.1 Delete in its entirety and substitute:

"3.5.1.2.1.1 Thermostat and safety controls. The thermostat shall regulate drying air temperature to a maximum of 350°F at the point of entry into the tunnel. Safety disconnect switches shall be provided to prevent operation when machine is being serviced and a high temperature limiting switch shall be provided in the heater circuit. The machine shall be equipped with a hot air thermostat and a circuit breaker or fuse panel. A means shall be provided to indicate tunnel air operating temperature. All controls shall be mounted on the front side of the cabinet."

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3.6 Delete in its entirety and substitute:

"3.6 Performance. When tested as specified in 4.7.1, the tunnel shall be capable of processing the required number of garments per hour as indicated in Table I. Fabric appearance in the dried and finished garments shall be wrinkle free and approximate 4.0 durable press rating when compared with applicable AATCC Durable Press Fabric Appearance Replicas."

Table I. Delete in its entirety and substitute:

"TABLE I. Capacity

	Garments Per Hour		
		Type I	Type II
Size	(30 min) Wet (35 ± 5% moisture	Damp (lightly extracted) (20 ± 5% moisture)	Dry (5 ± 1% moisture)
1	-	-	100
2	-	-	250
3	120	180	800
4	180	270	1200
5	400	600	1800

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4.7.1 Delete in its entirety and substitute:

"4.7.1 Functional test. Tunnels furnished under this specification shall be connected to necessary utility services and operated with laundered and/or dry cleaned garments for 2 hours through complete steaming and drying cycles at the machine's rated capacity. Performance characteristics of the machine shall be determined with laundered and/or dry cleaned garments in the following manner: Fifty garments manufactured in accordance with MIL-T-43853 - Trousers, Men's, Tan 445, Durable Press, Class 1 (50/50 polyester/cotton - 6.0 oz sq/yd) shall be weighed under ambient conditions to the nearest ounce. The weighed garments shall then be saturated in the following manner:

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TABLE III. Test sample

Operation	Time Minutes	Water Level	Temperature Degrees F	Supplies/100 lbs. Synthetic Detergent*
Suds	5	High	140°F	16 oz. (by volume)
Rinse	3	High	125°F	None
Rinse	3	High	110°F	None
Rinse	3	High	90°F	None

*Detergent, Laundry, Type II - FSN 7930-252-6979"

Equipment used for laundering shall be of such capacity that the load is not greater than 2/3 the rated machine capacity.

For processing wet garments in a Type I tunnel, garment shall be removed from the washer, hung on hangers, allowed to drip for 30 minutes and then processed immediately. Shirts shall be buttoned at one or more places. Trousers shall be hung by the waist with the front closure fastened at the top. Finished garments shall be dried to the extent that no visible evidence of moisture is evident.

For processing damp or lightly extracted garments in Type I equipment, the garments shall be removed from the washer and extracted to 20 $\pm$ 5% (from the dry weight) moisture content in a centrifugal extractor. The extracted garments shall then be hung on hangers for processing. Shirts shall be buttoned at one or more places. Trousers shall be hung by the waist with the front enclosure fastened. Finished garments shall be dried to the extent that no visible evidence of moisture is evident.

For processing laundering garments through Type II equipment, the garments shall be laundered and tumble dried at 160°F $\pm$ 5°F until dry (5 + 1% moisture). The last five minutes of the drying cycle shall be a cool down period with all drier heat shut-off. The garments shall be immediately removed from the drier and hung on hangers for processing.

Dry cleaned garments shall be processed through Type II equipment after dry cleaning and deodorizing.

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Fabric appearance in the dried and finished garments shall be compared with applicable AATCC Durable Press Fabric Appearance Replicas. Evaluation shall be made by an experienced observer. Inability of the tunnel to meet the hourly capability specified in Table I, or produce garments with the fabric appearance rating specified shall constitute test failure."

4.7.2, last line. Change "3.5.1.2.1.1" to "3.5.1".

Custodians:

Army - GL
Air Force - 45

User activities:

Navy - YD, SH

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

Project No. 3510-A249

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